AI Training for Beginners

A self-study training for using AI chatbots **safely, sensibly and with cost awareness**. Vendor-neutral – everything works with any common service (e.g. ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot). No prior knowledge needed.

What this training is worth

A comparable AI training for beginners – accompanied, with tests and personal support – would typically cost **around 250–350 € per person**. You get this material here **completely free of charge**, under an open license. That license is expressly limited to non-commercial use: anyone may use, share and adapt this material freely – but nobody may sell it or make money with it. This is possible because many people have contributed their time for free.

In return, we ask for something – but not money:

- **Take it seriously:** Actually work through the exercises. A training that is only read achieves little.
- **Pass it on:** Show it to people who know nothing about AI but would benefit from it.
- **Help out:** Ask questions, report outdated passages, contribute your experiences to the FAQ or the material. That is how the training gets better for everyone.
- If you would still like to donate something, feel free to use the sponsor button further up.

How to start

1. Read the introduction handout: `00_introduction_handout` – about 15 min., contains the five safety rules and the “Getting ready to start” checklist.
2. Choose your learning path (quick start, standard or advanced) – details in the roadmap (`AI-Training_Roadmap`).
3. Work through the topics in numerical order. Per topic (about 25–30 min.): read the cheatsheet → do the exercise → extra exercises if needed → test after the block.
4. Tick off your progress: `05_progress/learning_progress`

Material overview

Folder / file	Content
`00_introduction_handout`	Introduction handout (start here)
`01_cheatsheets/`	Cheatsheets, each about one page
`02_extra_exercises/`	Extra tasks for every topic (★ / ★★ / ★★★)
`03_tests/`	Entrance test and block tests incl. solutions (separate)
`04_trainer/`	Question template and FAQ
`05_progress/`	Checklist to tick off
`AI-Training_Roadmap`	Learning paths and topic plan in detail

Current status of the material

- **All 24 topics** (blocks A–F) are fully worked out: cheatsheets 01–24 and extra exercises 01–23.
- **Tests:** Entrance test, Quick test: quick start, block tests A–F and final test – each with a separate solutions file.
- **Support:** Question template (GitHub issues) and FAQ available.

License

This material is licensed under the CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (Attribution – NonCommercial – ShareAlike 4.0 International): Non-commercial use, adaptation and sharing with attribution is permitted; adaptations must be shared under the same license. Commercial use – such as selling the material or using it in paid trainings – requires separate permission from the authors.

Questions?

If you get stuck on an exercise, open an **issue** in this GitHub repo – ideally using the template from `04_trainer/question_template` and the FAQ in `04_trainer/faq`. Issues are public: anonymize prompts and results before you include them, and do not write any sensitive or personal data.

As of: October 2026